

Anton Liutin

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EDUCATION

- PhD, Agricultural & Applied Economics** 2021 – Expected May 2027
University of Wisconsin–Madison — dissertator. Advisor: Paul Castañeda Dower
- MA, Economics** 2020
New Economic School, Moscow, Russia
Thesis: “Polygamy and Inequality in a Male-Dominant Society” (advisor: Hosny Zoabi)
- BS, Theoretical Physics** 2018
National Research Nuclear University MEPhI (Moscow Engineering Physics Institute), Moscow, Russia

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Water and natural-resource economics · development economics · institutional and political economy · behavioral and experimental economics · economic history

Methods: Machine learning and text-as-data · spatial econometrics and remote sensing · network and graph methods · field and framed experiments

JOB MARKET PAPER

“When Scarcity Reveals Directional Network Interdependence: Evidence from Arizona Canals”

Full working draft. Links 54,946 Arizona fields to a directed canal network over 2016–2023. The association between upstream cropping and a satellite yield proxy becomes more negative during sustained drought, with no corresponding downstream change beyond 10 km. Historical drought comparisons and measured canal flow support an interpretation in which system slack masks delivery frictions until sustained scarcity makes them consequential.

WORKING PAPERS

“When Efficiency Cannot Substitute for Allocation: Technology Adoption in a Sequential Canal” (with Jamshid Shukurullaev)

Working draft. Framed field experiment with 190 farmers across four regions, drawing participants from the IFPRI farmer survey; conducted with CGIAR SPIA support.

“Double Vision: Donor Information, Farmer Voice, and Irrigation Policy Reform in Uzbekistan” (with Muzna Alvi, Paul Castañeda Dower, and Claudia Ringler)

Sets about 330,000 farmer Telegram messages against media coverage, donor documents, and legislation to ask whose concerns the law follows. Four state newspapers OCR'd in house; six channels classified in two languages by an ensemble of language models, checked against an expert-coded sample. IFPRI collaboration.

“Water Conservation Through Simplified Drip Irrigation Scheduling for Cotton Cultivation in Uzbekistan” (Jamshid Shukurullaev, Ahmad Hamidov, and Anton Liutin)

Complete manuscript. Three-season paired field validation plus a 32-farmer adoption panel (difference-in-differences).

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Impact Evaluation of Drip Irrigation in Uzbekistan” (with Paul Castañeda Dower, Muzna Alvi, and Claudia Ringler)

Survey-based impact evaluation of drip-irrigation adoption using the 2024 farmer survey; IFPRI / CGIAR NEXUS Gains collaboration.

Community testimony and environmental change in Alaska (with Paul Castañeda Dower)

Language-model analysis of over a million turns of hearing testimony and regulatory comment from Alaska communities, paired with satellite measurements of environmental change.

PRESENTATIONS

New Economic School Brown Bag Seminar (online) April 2026

“From Position to Exposure: Drought Amplification in Directed Water Networks”

Central Asian Economics Conference, Astana, Kazakhstan August 2025

“Using Behavioral Games to Understand Water-Saving Technology Adoption in Uzbekistan”

CGIAR SPIA Webinar (online) August 2024

“Behavioral Games to Explore Water-Saving Technology Adoption in Uzbekistan”

NEXUS Gains / WEFE Central Asia Summer School, Tashkent, Uzbekistan “Water-Saving Technologies in Uzbekistan”	August 2023
Departmental seminars, University of Wisconsin–Madison Regular presenter: DevLab, Environment and Resource Economics Seminar, and Student Research Colloquium	2022 – 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Paul Castañeda Dower University of Wisconsin–Madison — community institutions and adaptation in Alaska: language-model analysis of hearing testimony and regulatory comment, paired with satellite measurements of environmental change	Summer 2026
Research Assistant, Dustin Frye and Gisella Kagy University of Wisconsin–Madison — environmental health and economic history	Fall 2024 – Summer 2025
Research Assistant, Paul Castañeda Dower University of Wisconsin–Madison — Russian economic history	Summer 2023
Research Assistant, Corbett Grainger University of Wisconsin–Madison — environmental and natural-resource economics	Summer 2022 – Spring 2023
Research Assistant, Andrei Markevich New Economic School — Russian economic history	Winter 2020 – Summer 2021
Junior Researcher, Hosny Zoabi New Economic School, Research Department — family and growth economics	Winter 2020 – Summer 2021
Junior Researcher P.N. Lebedev Physical Institute, Russian Academy of Sciences	Winter 2017 – Summer 2018

FIELDWORK

Uzbekistan — framed field experiment on water-saving technology adoption Designed and ran a lab-in-the-field experiment with 190 farmers across four regions, with Jamshid Shukurullaev; supported by CGIAR SPIA.	Nov – Dec 2024
Uzbekistan — large-scale farmer survey (IFPRI / CGIAR NEXUS Gains) Prepared and fielded a survey of small and large farmers across five regions; trained and monitored local enumerators.	Sep – Nov 2024
Uzbekistan — qualitative fieldwork on water-saving technologies Conducted focus-group discussions and in-depth farmer interviews across seven regions on the adoption of water-saving technologies, with Paul Castañeda Dower in collaboration with IFPRI.	Summer 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, AAE 636: Applied Econometric Analysis I University of Wisconsin–Madison — graduate applied econometrics	Fall 2026
Co-Instructor, AAE Math Camp University of Wisconsin–Madison — calculus and probability for incoming graduate students	Summer 2026
Teaching Assistant, AAE 350: World Hunger and Malnutrition University of Wisconsin–Madison — led four weekly discussion sections (cross-listed with Nutritional Sciences)	Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant, AAE 215: Introduction to Agricultural and Applied Economics University of Wisconsin–Madison — undergraduate introduction to agricultural economics	Fall 2023
Teaching Assistant, Development Economics (MA) New Economic School — course by Michele Valsecchi	Fall 2020
Private Mathematics Tutor Prepared students for mathematics-intensive economics BA/MA programs (New Economic School, HSE).	2017 – 2022

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

University Fellowship, UW–Madison Nine-month university fellowship supporting first-year doctoral study (2021–22) and fifth-year dissertation research (2025–26).	2021–22, 2025–26
Deborah and David Penn Fund Research Presentation Award, UW–Madison (\$1,000) AAE Graduate Committee award supporting presentation at the Central Asian Economics Conference, Astana.	2025
CGIAR–SPIA Fellowship (\$25,500) Research fellowship awarded following external peer review; supported the behavioral-games field experiment in Uzbekistan (NEXUS Gains collaboration).	2023

CREECA Graduate Student Short-Term Research Award, UW–Madison (\$3,000)

2023

Competitive award for the project “Current Cooperation Problems under Common-Pool Resources in Uzbekistan.”

RESEARCH GRANTS AND PROJECTS

CGIAR GENDER Impact Platform, WEAI-Climate Learning Grant (\$100,000)

2023–24

“Unveiling the Nexus: Climate-Smart Irrigation and Women’s Empowerment in Uzbekistan.” Named collaborator (survey design, fieldwork, analysis); PIs Muzna Alvi and Claudia Ringler.

SPIA Supplemental Funding, IFPRI / NEXUS Gains team (\$40,950)

2024

Team funding for completion of survey, fieldwork, and outreach for the Uzbekistan research program; research-team member.

SPIA Scoping and Travel Grant (\$9,300)

2023

Joint grant for scoping and preparatory fieldwork in Uzbekistan; co-applicant with Paul Castañeda Dower.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming & software: Python (pandas, GeoPandas, NumPy, SciPy), Stata, ArcGIS, QGIS, LaTeX, Git

Machine learning & geospatial: Google Earth Engine (Sentinel-2, Landsat, OpenET); satellite and crop-sequence classification; directed-graph construction and validation at national scale

Text as data: LLM classification pipelines — in-house OCR (DocLayout-YOLO, Surya; Cyrillic), open-weight model ensembles with majority voting, validation against hand-coded gold standards

Languages: Russian (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Paul Castañeda Dower (advisor), Associate Professor, Agricultural & Applied Economics, UW–Madison — pdower@wisc.edu

Corbett Grainger, Professor, Agricultural & Applied Economics, UW–Madison — corbett.grainger@wisc.edu

Daniel Phaneuf, Henry C. Taylor Professor, Agricultural & Applied Economics, UW–Madison — dphaneuf@wisc.edu